a pitching session, where fellow participants will get to pitch the problems they've identified. It is also during this session where, the sponsors and the hosting companies will pitch their problem statements. These problem tracks usually have separate prizes for participants in these tracks. The problem statements proposed during this session, might change drastically when actually getting down to the making, but, it provides the general direction you would take during the course of the hackathon. It is at this time, that you need to identify your mentors and guides. Mentors and guides usually go around exploring all the projects being worked on, and you are free to use them to help with your project. The mentors and guides are usually experts in various fields like medicine, engineering, electronics, management, programming etc and they will be ready to provide assistance to you in any form necessary. In most hackathons, you will be working in groups of 2-5 and each person should preferably be from a different background or discipline so that you have a diverse group with inputs coming from various sources.

Every hackathon, which has any hardware aspect to it, will have a hack shop. A hackshop is a small set up where you will find hardware components and miscellaneous items which you can use during the hackathon to build your prototype. The components and materials are usually sponsored or funded by the organizers. The components might include prototyping boards such as Arduino, BeagleBone, Raspberry Pi and small components like LEDs, resistors to make electronic circuits. If it is a themed hackathon, you'll find more materials relevant to the theme. A medical hack, for instance might have a lot of medical equipment like masks, oxygen cylinders and such. There will also be components relevant to the tracks given by the companies hosting the hackathon. You can make use of all these components to build a prototype or just to explore and test out the different components. The hackshop is usually open only for a small part of the hackathon, so if you need components, you need to decide when the hackshop is open.

Once you gather everything you'll need for building your prototype, if you are building one, that is, you can gather with your team and start ideating on the problem and doing your research. Hackathons have solid internet connectivity, so it is very easy to do your research for a couple of hours. Once you have a good idea of what you aim to achieve, you need to set goals for your team. Hackathons achieve only around 70% of the tasks they wish to achieve, so it is best to set small goals and revise them if you have time to spare.